

Medical Necessity Review - Determination Letter

Review ID: MNR-2026-008834 | Date of Review: 06/22/2026

Claimant Information

Field	Value
Claimant Name (Test)	Jordan A. Kessler
Claim Number	PIP-2026-117743
Date of Injury	02/14/2026
Employer	Prairie Freight Logistics, Inc.
Jurisdiction	Missouri
Requested Service	Total Knee Arthroplasty, right knee (CPT 27447)
Diagnosis	M17.11 - Unilateral primary osteoarthritis, right knee
Requesting Provider	Dr. Elena Vasquez, MD, Orthopedic Surgery

Clinical Summary Submitted

Claimant is a 54-year-old warehouse forklift operator with a documented work-related injury to the right knee sustained 02/14/2026 after a fall from a loading dock. MRI dated 03/02/2026 confirms Kellgren-Lawrence Grade 4 osteoarthritis with full-thickness cartilage loss. Claimant completed 14 sessions of physical therapy (04/2026-05/2026) and received one corticosteroid injection (05/10/2026) with only temporary relief. Oxford Knee Score recorded at 19/48. BMI documented at 31.2. No active infection. HbA1c 6.1%. Non-smoker.

Guideline Cross-Reference

Reviewed against ODG-MSK-0417 (Total Knee Arthroplasty) and Missouri Division of Workers' Compensation treatment guidelines. Conservative treatment duration, imaging findings, and functional outcome scores were evaluated against the criteria specified in the referenced guideline.

Determination

Status: APPROVED

The requested procedure meets medical necessity criteria under ODG-MSK-0417: radiographic confirmation of Grade 4 osteoarthritis is present, conservative treatment of greater than 3 months is documented, and functional outcome scores support significant impairment. No additional review triggers were identified.

Reviewer

Dr. Marcus Ito, MD, Board-Certified Orthopedic Surgery
Peer Reviewer, Genex Medical Review Services
License #: MO-88213 (test data)

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